

track info

tracks 32-34

Dave K ventures into the murky uncharted territory of flatpicking

32. Introduction

33. Full track

34. Backing track

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rating info

beginner easy moderate hard



rating: easy to moderate

The piece is fairly straightforward although, as always, there are a few bits to look out for here and there.

richard ecclestone

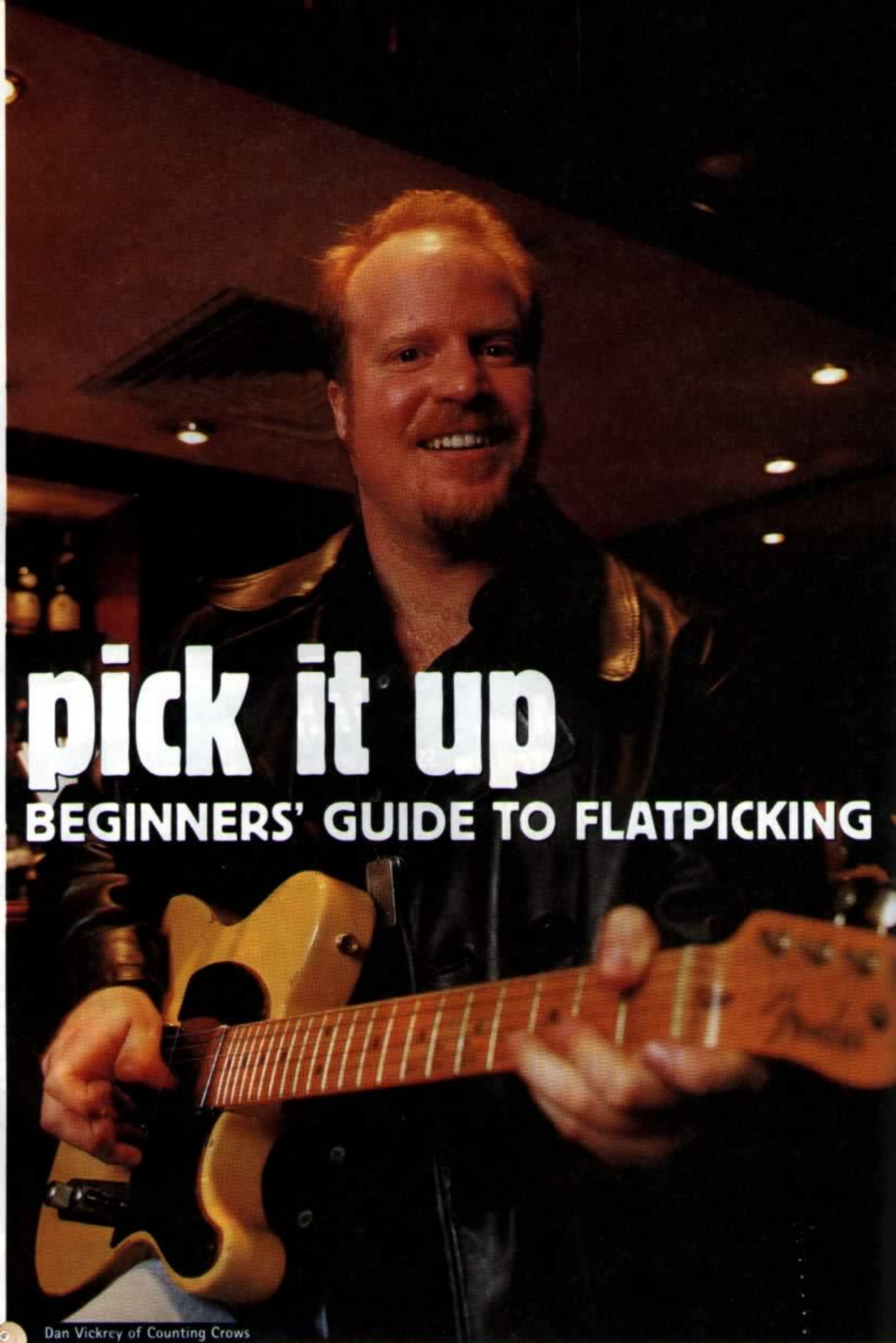
meet your **gt** tutor: dave kilminster

■ Dave won the inaugural Guitarist Of The Year competition back in 1991 and has been writing for **gt** since the first issue. He also has a regular column in our sister magazine *Guitarist* and teaches at the ACM in Guildford. On top of all that he still finds time to play live and is currently touring with the band 'Qango' featuring John Wetton (ex Asia and King Crimson) on vocals and bass and Carl Palmer (ex Emerson Lake and Palmer) on drums. Look out for UK dates and some Italian gigs shortly afterwards. Dave's playing can also be heard on the live John Wetton album *Nomansland* (out now) and on his second solo album, which should be out soon.



pick it up

BEGINNERS' GUIDE TO FLATPICKING



Dan Vickrey of Counting Crows

Want to improve your flatpicking? Not even sure what flatpicking is? Well, this could just be the lesson for you.

Well, it looks like summer is finally on the way so I thought I'd write a happy tune this month in the style of those clean-living Yanks the Counting Crows. I've been listening to the *Satellites* album recently so I should credit Adam and the boys for some of the inspiration for this month's piece, which I've entitled 'Counting Hedgehogs' (at least I think that's what our local farmer calls them).

Let's start with the first chord, which is an easy variation of a bog-standard G major chord. By simply including the open top E string, the

chord becomes a G major sixth. Why is this? Well, look at the G major scale:

G	A	B	C	D	E	F#	G
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	1

The E is the sixth note (yes, it really is that easy!). As I'm not playing the A string I used this shape (see **Picture 1**). Try to mute (or dampen) the A string by touching it with the underside of your second finger to prevent it from accidentally sounding (or feeding back if you're playing particularly loudly).



take six
Fingering for the opening G6 chord



all thumbs
Fret the F# with the thumb



easy, like
A straightforward fingering arrangement



can you C?
Another straightforward chord to fret



minor moves
Fretting the A minor chord



major moves
Change to D major as shown



funky seven
Move up to the fifth fret for the D7

the pick's the thing

At first glance the picking strokes may appear a little odd, but it's a very logical approach and makes playing this type of tune a lot easier. In essence, the right hand utilises a constant down-up motion, even when not actually picking a string. This helps you to keep in time and adds to the smooth flow of the music.

jargon buster



flatpicking

The art of articulating lines or arpeggiating chords with a single plectrum as opposed to using fingerpicks, hybrid picking (pick and fingers) or by simply ditching the pick altogether such as on classical guitar.



REMEMBER terms and signs are fully explained on page 92

For the second chord, I recommend using the thumb for the low F# as in **Picture 2**.

Bear in mind that you don't have to get your thumb all the way around the neck. It's usually sufficient to just catch the string with the side of the thumb. It might feel a little difficult at first but stick with it as it's an incredibly useful technique. You'll find that you can't really play most Hendrix songs without it (that may or may not be an incentive!).

The next two chord shapes are pretty straightforward, as you can see probably tell from **Pictures 3 and 4**.

Be sure to use pull offs at the end of bar 4. These are achieved by first plucking the C note (B string, 1st fret) and pulling your first finger off the string with a slight sideways motion to sound the open B string. Next, fret the A (G string, 2nd fret) with the second finger, pluck it and then pull the second finger off the string, once again using the slight sideways motion, to produce the open G string.

gt info

further listening

There's a whole flock of artists to check out such as Sheryl Crow, the Black Crowes and, of course, Counting Crows (although you may want to avoid their latest release!). And of course there's Neil Young (Harvest), Crosby, Stills and Nash (and Young) or my favourite acoustic guitarist of all time, Michael Hedges.



sound advice

dave's gtCD gear

For recording this month's piece I used John Wetton's Yairi, which is the same guitar as in the pictures (I've had it on loan since 1998 but don't remind him). Although the guitar has a pick-up, we miked it up for a more realistic sound and used a little reverb for ambience.



ganging up

G major triad played at the 7th fret



moving down

D major triad at the 5th fret

anchors away?

There seem to be different theories on this but what I do is anchor my hand to the guitar in some way so that I have a point of reference. In other words so that I don't have to watch my hand all the time. Some teachers and other players say that you shouldn't anchor the hand, (especially to the top of an acoustic guitar as that's where it resonates) so where I usually rest it is on the bridge. This, of course, is physically connected to the top of the guitar but to my ears doesn't seem to affect the tone quite as much. If you're a beginner it may seem to be a bit early to talk about things like this but I think it's better to start off with good habits instead of practising bad ones.

For the 'B' section of the piece I used a fairly easy strumming pattern and went between A minor (see Picture 5) and D major (see Picture 6), with a funky little D7 on the fifth fret to finish it all off



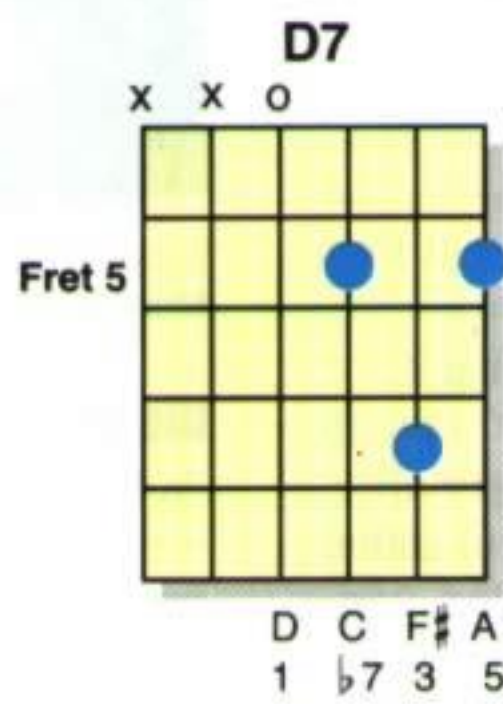
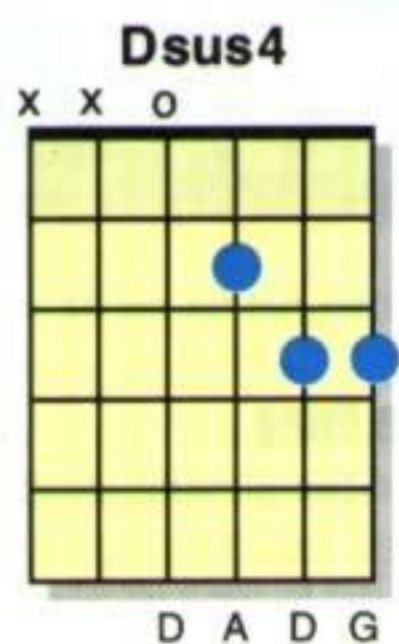
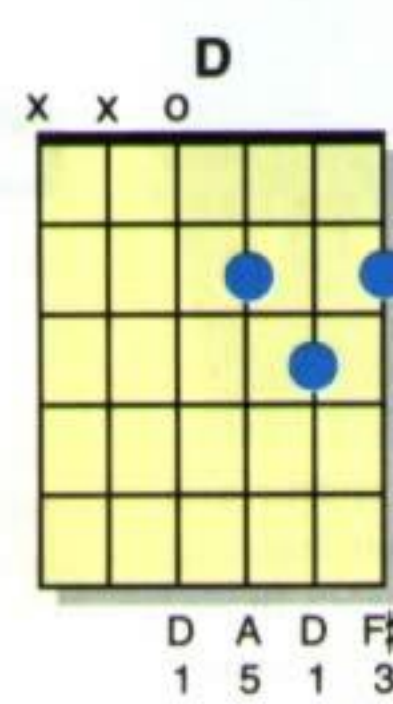
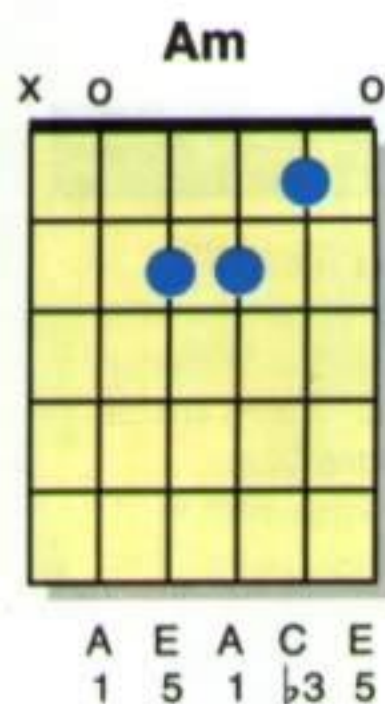
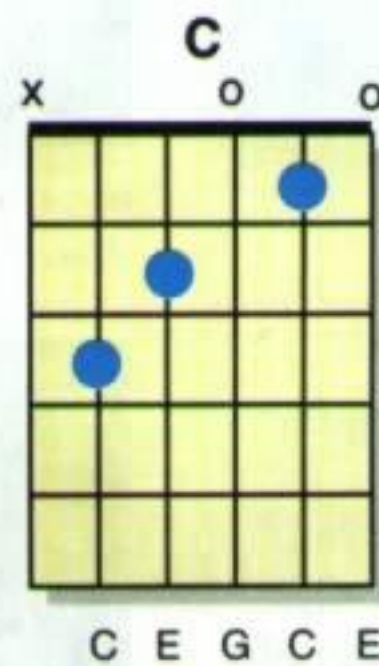
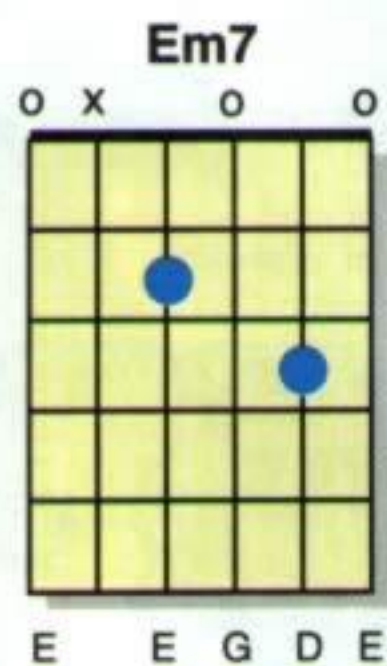
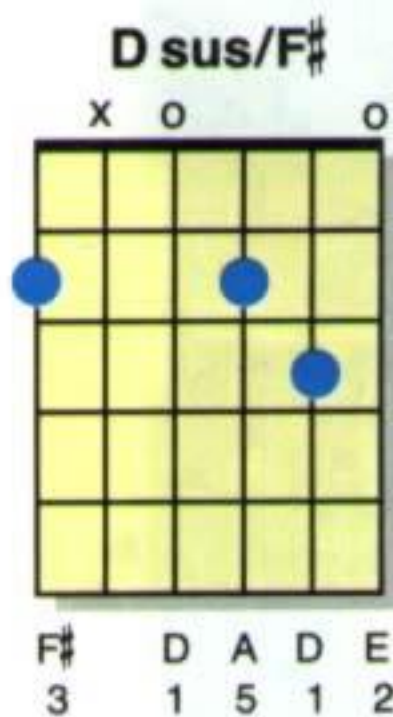
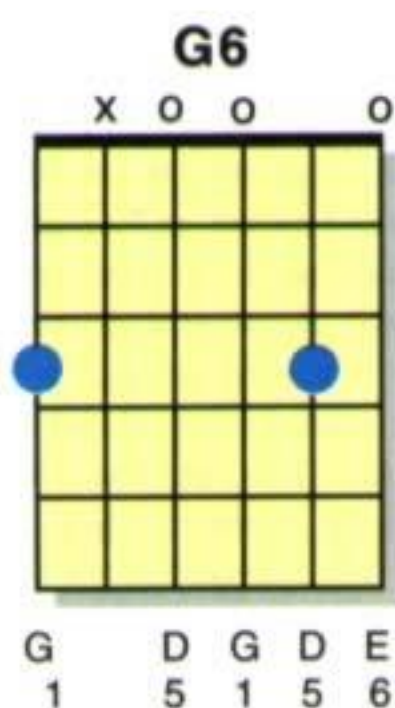
finishing off

The E minor triad

(see Picture 7).

The Dsus4 chords are produced by simply placing your little finger on the top E string, third fret of the D major chord.

counting hedgehogs chord diagrams



not only, but also

When I was recording this piece I could hear in my head a nice little counterpoint phrase using triads, so I've included the music for that as well; again pay particularly special attention to the pick strokes and take your time to get it right. You'll find that the ones I've written are the most effective. Here's what the triads look like: First, the G major triad at the 7th fret is shown in Picture 8, while the D major triad at the 5th fret is shown in Picture 9. The E minor triad at the third fret looks suspiciously like that in Picture 10.

For the final C major triad simply play the same shape as the D major triad but down (towards the headstock) two frets so that it's around the third fret.

Once again, take your time with this piece, and you'll find that the techniques you acquire from playing this tune properly will be useful to you forever. Enjoy the tune and I'll see you next month. **gt**



counting hedgehogs... continued

11

Am

D D7

gliss

S

13

G6

Dsus2/F#

15

Em7

C

Rall

PO PO

G

Guitar Overdub

Let ring

etc

1

5